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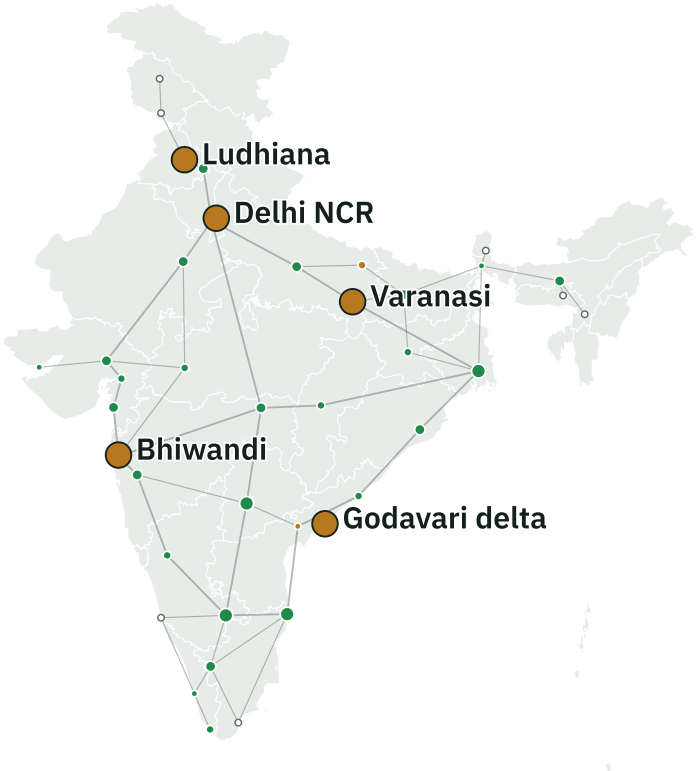
Konaseema orders miss Dhanteras unless they ship by Saturday

● NETWORK: AMBER

BEFORE DIWALI · 8 DAYS TO DHANTERAS · 10 DAYS TO DIWALI

For e-commerce, D2C and consumer-goods teams delivering orders and stocking shops through Diwali.

Two days after Cyclone Arnab came ashore near Yanam, traffic was back at only 20 of the 57 damaged spots on Andhra's state roads[1]. Orders for Konaseema and West Godavari need up to three extra days, so anything shipped after Saturday may miss Dhanteras on the 6th. Arnab's rain sits over eastern Uttar Pradesh (UP) until the 31st[2], and trains from Delhi and Mumbai to east UP are already full for 6 and 7 November[3].



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for peak week: busy, but delivery promises hold
● AMBER something is slowing deliveries beyond normal peak
● RED deliveries largely stopped across a state or city, or a courier embargo on the route

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Wed 21 Oct** Delhi on Stage I of GRAP, its pollution action plan: no truck curbs yet[4]
- **Sat 31 Oct** Last dispatch for Dhanteras to the Godavari delta
- **Fri 6 – Sat 7 Nov** Warehouse crews leave Delhi, Ludhiana and Mumbai
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham
- **Fri 13 – Mon 16 Nov** Chhath keeps east UP and Bihar crews away from city hubs

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+1*	+1*	+2–3*	+0	+0	+0
AMBER	AMBER	AMBER	GREEN	GREEN	GREEN

* Likely impact (#days) on delivery promise up to Diwali within the region, specific to certain cities or pincodes, beyond what is expected for the season.

Arnab leaves the Godavari delta's roads broken, and takes its rain to east UP

South, North · Konaseema and West Godavari; Varanasi, Prayagraj and the Vindhya belt

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

By Wednesday evening Andhra had traffic back at only 20 of the 57 damaged spots on its roads, with one road breached, so vans for the delta are still held up, Deccan Chronicle reports[1]. Can a van reach the delta towns today? Some can, slowly.

- **Konaseema and West Godavari** South · +2 to +3 days Damaged and breached roads slow every van; I'd expect the delay to last until at least Monday, and delta towns to recover last.
- **Eastern UP and the Vindhya belt** North · +1 day Storm and rain alerts from the 28th to the 31st[2]; I'd expect vans between Varanasi, Prayagraj and their towns to run a day late.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Set promises for Konaseema and West Godavari pin codes (533 and 534) at +3 from today, or orders shipped after Saturday miss Dhanteras.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Top-ups to shops in the delta towns move from Saturday at the earliest; load them first when the state roads clear.
- Gifting stock that lands after Diwali goes unsold, so send sweets and dry fruits for the delta and east UP by Mon 2 Nov.

What next: A new circulation over the south Andaman Sea may become a low and drift north-northwest into the Bay, IMD says, with no firm track yet[5]. If it heads for Andhra, the delta's recovery stalls again.

Warehouse crews start leaving on Dhanteras eve: trains home to east UP are full

North, West · Delhi NCR, Ludhiana and Mumbai warehouses; Basti, Gorakhpur and the east UP towns their crews go home to

AMBER · MEDIUM COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Amar Ujala's Basti edition reports on the trains home[3]. The Bandra Express from Mumbai on 6 November has a waiting list of 160 in third AC, and the Satyagrah Express from Delhi on the 7th has 160 in sleeper. So who sorts the Dhanteras parcels on the 6th? Well, fewer people: those trains carry the people who load trucks, sort parcels and ride delivery bikes in the big cities, and many stay home through Chhath, 13–16 November.

- **Delhi NCR and Ludhiana** North · +1 day I'd expect sort centres and warehouses to run short-handed from 6 Nov, so dispatches run a day late.
- **Mumbai and Bhiwandi** West · +1 day The same from 6 Nov for the warehouses that ship west India's orders, so dispatches there run late too, my estimate.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Get Dhanteras and Diwali orders out of Delhi, Ludhiana and Mumbai warehouses by Thu 5 Nov, before the crews thin and dispatches slow.
- Add a day to promises shipped from those warehouses from 6 Nov, and hold it until crews are back after Chhath.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- Plan the restart from Delhi and Mumbai depots on short crews from 12 Nov; I wouldn't count on full crews before 20 Nov.

Jammu–Srinagar highway (NH-44)

North · Open both ways to trucks; tankers beyond Chenani at night only

GREEN

Goods vehicles, heavy ones included, could run both ways on Wednesday, weather allowing, Kashmir Life reports from the traffic police advisory[6]. Oil and gas tankers bound for Kashmir move beyond Chenani only from 5 pm to 5 am. I'd expect Diwali stock for the Valley to arrive on time, though one landslide can still stop it for a day.

SOURCES

Built from public sources only. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. If I am wrong, we'll find out in the subsequent weeks. Cost of delay: High: the delivery misses Dhanteras or Diwali, so the sale is lost or the order comes back; Medium: late, but still before the festival, or stock reaches shops after peak buying; Low: a delay with little effect on sales.

1. Deccan Chronicle: Arnab claims nine lives, devastates crops in 14 districts, 28 Oct
2. UNI: Arnab to hit several districts of UP, 28 Oct
3. Amar Ujala (Basti): no confirmed berths on express trains for Diwali, 29 Oct
4. Outlook: GRAP Stage I invoked in Delhi-NCR, 21 Oct
5. Pragativadi: new circulation in the south Andaman Sea may turn into a low, 28 Oct
6. Kashmir Life: Jammu–Srinagar highway open both ways, 28 Oct